Business

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Anthropic released the long-awaited prospectus for its IPO , which promises to be one of the largest ever, if not the largest. Revenue soared from $787m in the second quarter of 2025 to $11.6bn in the same quarter this year. Its spending on personnel, including stock-based compensation, rose from $320m to nearly $1.9bn. Anthropic reported a net loss of $66.3bn for the quarter, mostly because of an accounting charge related to the reassessment of the fair value of debt that could be converted into shares. It actually made an operating profit of $974m in the second quarter, compared with an operating loss of almost $1.7bn in the preceding three months. Anthropic’ s stock-market debut could happen in November.

More funding deals were announced in AI. With tech companies increasingly turn to Wall Street and capital markets to fund their investments, Broadcom is setting up a $63bn special-purpose vehicle with Bank of America and other financial firms. The SPV will buy Broadcom’ s chips and networking equipment and lease them to Anthropic. Meta is raising $37.5bn through stock offerings. It also plans to raise up to $60bn through periodic sales of newly issued shares, starting next year.

Alphabet’ s share price sank, after it emerged that the rate at which it is burning through cash was much higher than markets had expected. Microsoft’ s stock fared better, after it reported lower capital expenditures than Wall Street had forecast, mostly because of delays in building new data centres. Seeking to keep costs under control, Microsoft wants to shed 60,000 employees, a quarter of its global workforce, through a “voluntary exit offer” that will give staff “who may be considering a future outside the company a new choice to make that transition”.

Skydance also offered a “voluntary buy-out” plan to staff as part of its effort to cut costs following its takeover of Warner Bros. It told remaining employees that from now on they would have to work in the office five days a week, because “in a creative company like ours, the best ideas come from people in the same room”.

The British government unveiled its budget , the first under Andy Burnham as prime minister and John Healey as chancellor. Among the measures, the budget raised the bank corporation-tax surcharge from 3% to 6% for 15 months to help pay for household-energy relief . Businesses will benefit from a freeze or cut in property taxes, meaning that half of all retail, hospitality and leisure properties will pay no property tax at all. From 2028, mayors and local authorities will have the power to impose a tourist tax. The government also committed to a target to spend 3% of GDP on defence by 2030, but left the details of how this would be funded to a spending review next year.

Christine Lagarde announced that she would step down as president of the European Central Bank in February, nine month before the official end of her term. Ms Lagarde became the ECB's president in 2019 and did not expect to be in the job for so long, but she said she was leaving "with a sense of good work done". She has been talking to the World Economic Forum about possibly becoming its chairwoman. The European Council will appoint her successor at the ECB, with candidates from the Netherlands and Spain currently leading the pack. Meanwhile, the ECB's governing council made no changes to interest rates when it met in Frankfurt.

The Federal Reserve also kept interest rates on hold at its latest meeting, leaving its benchmark rate in the 3.75-4% range. Kevin Warsh, the Fed's chairman, promised to continue dispensing "new monetary medicine" to bring inflation under control. Markets think the Fed will raise rates over the coming months.

The American economy grew by 3.4% in the third quarter at an annualised rate, up from 2.2% in the second quarter. Before the figures were released Mr Warsh noted that economic growth had strengthened, and described consumer spending and capital expenditures as "healthy".

The IPO of JIO Platforms was a success, raising $3.1bn. The share price of the Indian telecoms company rose by 27% on the first day of trading, leaving it with a market capitalisation of $137bn. Jio will use the proceeds to pay debt accrued as it furthers its ambitions in AI and satellite broadband.

Boeing's stock took a dive, after the company confirmed it would miss production and delivery targets for its 737 aircraft this year. Its commercial-airline division reported a quarterly operating loss of $697m, more than analysts had expected, but profits from defence, space and security surged to $492m.

Audi announced that it will build a $4bn factory in Georgia, its first plant in America. The factory will produce 200,000 sport-utility vehicles a year, creating 4,500 jobs, even as Audi's parent company, Volkswagen, slashes 100,000 jobs. Gernot Döllner, Audi's boss, made the announcement with Donald Trump at a campaign rally in Georgia. The president said Audi's decision would not have happened "without tariffs": European cars that are made in America are exempt from the duties.

The carmaking industry's evolution to a focus on high tech was underscored by the decision of General Motors to switch its share listing from the New York Stock Exchange to the Nasdaq. The Nasdaq is a natural home for our "technology-driven strategy", GM said. The company recently highlighted how it is "using frontier AI and machine-learning breakthroughs to accelerate development" in autonomous driving.